

What Yonkers Residents Complain About

The leading grievances in public comments on the City of Yonkers' official
Facebook and Instagram accounts
March – November 2023

Period analysed	March – November 2023
Months carrying comments	Mar 2023 – Nov 2023
Comments collected	1,304
Of which substantive	691 (excludes emoji-only and tag-only replies)
Complaints identified	56 (8.1% of substantive)
Sources	facebook.com/cityofyonkers · instagram.com/cityofyonkers
Prepared	August 08, 2026

How this was built

Public comments were collected from the City of Yonkers' official Facebook page and Instagram account covering March – November 2023. Every comment was screened for grievance language — complaint markers such as demands to fix something, reports of neglect, questions about why a problem persists, or explicit expressions of frustration. Comments that were purely congratulatory, informational, or off-topic were excluded from the counts.

1,304 comments were collected. A large share of any city page's replies are emoji, tags and one-word reactions, which express no grievance either way, so the **691** comments carrying actual prose form the base for every rate in this report. Of those, **56 (8.1%)** registered as complaints and were sorted into civic categories using a weighted keyword classifier. A single comment can touch more than one issue; it is counted once under its dominant theme, with secondary themes tracked separately under “mentions.”

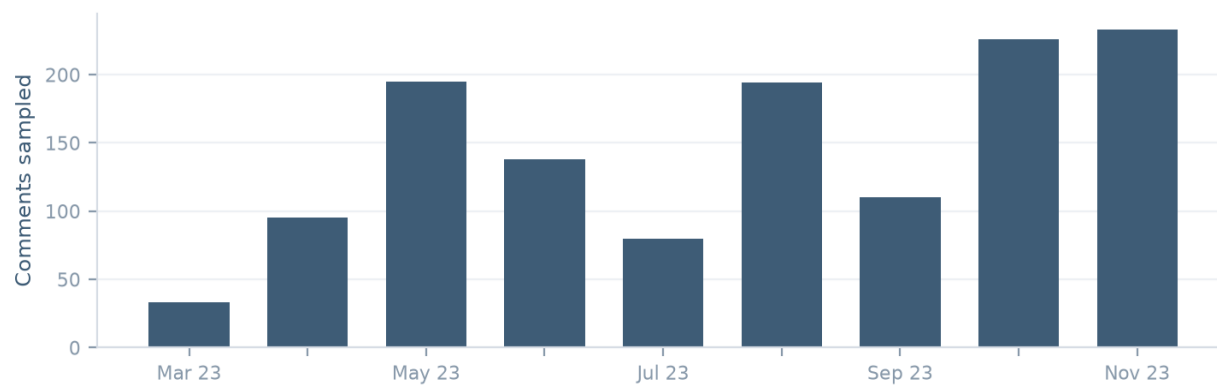
What the numbers do and don't represent

These are the complaints residents chose to post publicly on the city's own channels. They are a strong signal of what frustrates the engaged public, but they are not a representative survey of all Yonkers residents. Comment volume is also shaped by what the city posts about and by moderation. Read the ranking as *what dominates the public conversation*, not as a measured incidence of each problem across the city.

Collection notes

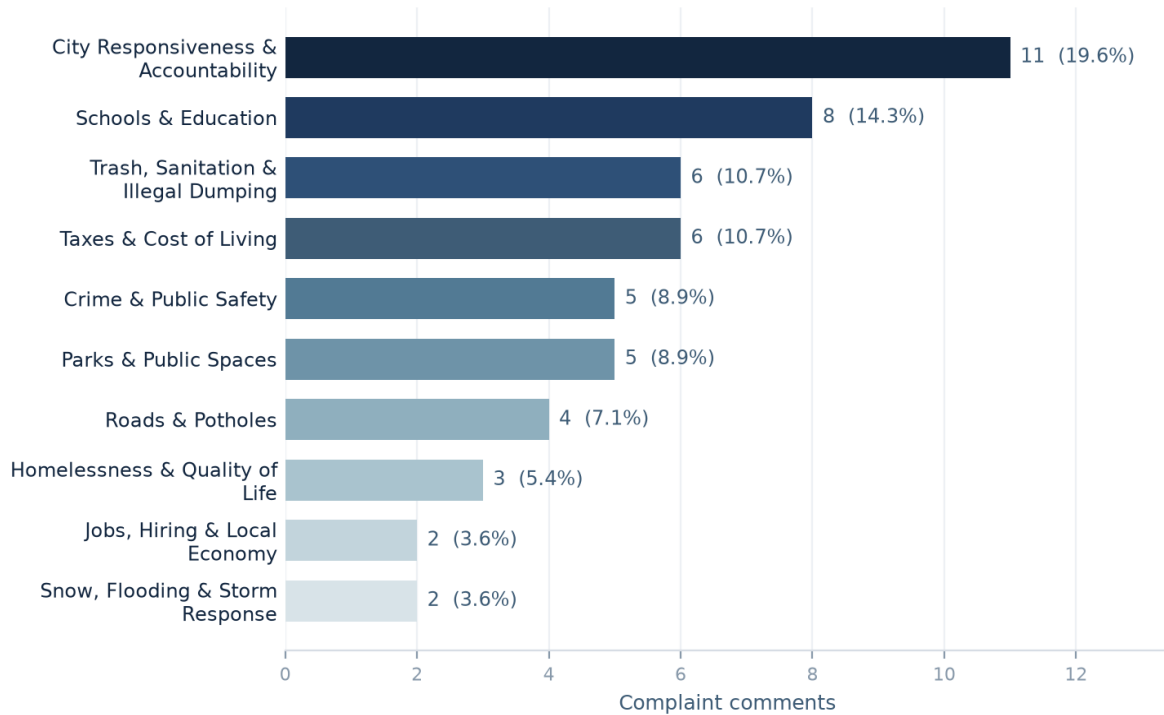
- Coverage for this window: 165 Facebook posts and 732 Instagram posts were sampled. Facebook's public feed is paged in date-bounded slices, so this is a sample of the period rather than every post the city published in it.
- The city's pages drew far less engagement in this period than they do now - many posts carry no comments at all - so the complaint counts here are much smaller than in recent years. Compare shares between periods rather than raw counts.
- Facebook comments were pulled from the most-commented posts inside the window. Heavily discussed posts are over-represented on purpose - that is where grievances collect - so these shares describe the complaint conversation, not the average post.
- Instagram contributes the comments returned alongside each post, a broader but shallower slice than Facebook.
- Emoji-only, tag-only and one-word reactions are counted in the total collected but excluded from the base used for the complaint rate, since they express no grievance either way.
- Comments posted by official city accounts are excluded, as the scrapers surface them alongside residents' replies.
- A category can rank low simply because the city rarely posted about it in this window. Treat the ranking as a measure of the conversation the city's own posts invited, not a census of civic opinion.

Comments sampled by month



The top 10 complaints

City Responsiveness & Accountability is the single largest source of complaints, accounting for 19.6% of every grievance posted. The three leading themes — City Responsiveness & Accountability, Schools & Education, Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping — together make up 45% of all complaints, meaning most of what residents raise on the city's channels concentrates in a handful of recurring issues.

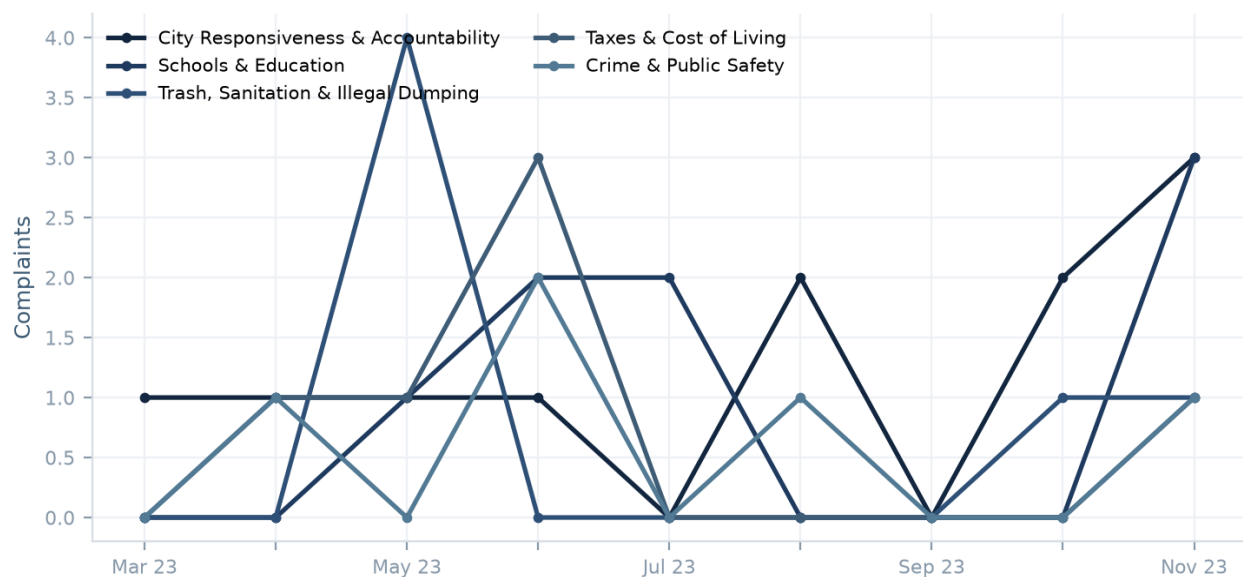


#	Complaint category	Comments	Share	Avg. likes
1	City Responsiveness & Accountability	11	19.6%	1.5
2	Schools & Education	8	14.3%	0.2
3	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	6	10.7%	0.3
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	6	10.7%	0.0
5	Crime & Public Safety	5	8.9%	0.4
6	Parks & Public Spaces	5	8.9%	1.4
7	Roads & Potholes	4	7.1%	1.0
8	Homelessness & Quality of Life	3	5.4%	0.0
9	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	2	3.6%	1.5
10	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	2	3.6%	2.0

How the top issues moved over time

Monthly complaint counts for the five largest categories. Peaks follow a specific triggering event — a snowstorm, a violent incident, a budget vote — that pulls a burst of comment traffic onto the city's posts.

Read month-to-month movement with care. These lines track how much was sampled as much as how much was said — a month with few sampled comments cannot produce many complaints. Check the sampling volume on the methodology page before reading any swing as a real change in resident sentiment.



The complaints in residents' own words

Each category below shows its rank, volume, and a selection of verbatim comments. Quotes are reproduced as posted, including spelling and punctuation. Commenter names are omitted.

1

City Responsiveness & Accountability

11 complaints · 19.6% of all complaints · Facebook 7 · Instagram 4



"If Spano keeps expanding term limits we will never have someone else. The self appointed king with the yonkers council the royal jesters"

Instagram · 2023 · on: "#MeetTheMayors | Since the year 1872, Yonkers has had 42 great Mayors that have moved our ..."

"This is the most corrupt law ever made ...!!!!"

Facebook · 2023 · 4 likes · on: "REMINDER The Yonkers City Code bans the use of gas-powered leaf blowers to help prot..."

"They love giving each other little awards and telling each other how special and great they are. When will the corruption stop?"

Instagram · 2023 · 4 likes · on: "CITY OF YONKERS DEDICATES MARTIN GINSBURG PARK IN GREYSTONE NEIGHBORHOOD LINKING WARBURTON..."

"Another corrupt business. With the same clowns going there with the big scissors. Hope he's not running it while he's on the clock"

Facebook · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "NEW BUSINESS ALERT Tony's Sandwich Shop & Deli 452 Saw Mill River Rd Known for ..."

2

Schools & Education

8 complaints · 14.3% of all complaints · Instagram 5 · Facebook 3



"Remind me again how it works? Yesterday, this car overtook a school bus on Saw Mill River Rd. He drove very fast and almost could have hit me! The yellow lights were on the school bus but the driver had already passed the bus before the stop sign and red lights turned on."

Facebook · 2023 · on: "Hey Yonkers! Check out this week's episode of Your Yonkers Now highlighting the activation..."

"The schools should be closed bc these kids are not going to wear masks plus the schools handed out the wrong mask today. It should be the N95 not a surgical mask. Smh I understand something is better than nothing but we can do much better for our staff and students."

Instagram · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "UPDATE ALL outdoor activities in the City of Yonkers including Parks programs have b..."

"When is the construction on Midland approaching McLean going to finish? They haven't done anything there in a month! Are they waiting for school to start to resume so that traffic becomes a mess??"

Instagram · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "#MeetTheMayors | Since the year 1872, Yonkers has had 42 great Mayors that have moved our ..."

"UNLESS YOU ARE SCHOOL OR CITY ,,, YEA THERE " BLOWERS" DONT DO THE SAME..."

Facebook · 2023 · on: "REMINDER The Yonkers City Code bans the use of gas-powered leaf blowers to help prot..."

3

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping

6 complaints · 10.7% of all complaints · Facebook 4 · Instagram 2



"If this is true then why aren't summonses given to the apartment buildings and homes that put the recyclables out with the garbage. I see it everyday and watch the sanitation people take it with the garbage. This city doesn't uphold the recycling laws. I want a good answer not an excuse or it being passed on to the next guy"

Instagram · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "On #NationalRecyclingDay, Yonkers takes a stand for a cleaner, greener tomorrow! ■ Our P..."

"Hope that included downtown yonkers, including Yonkers Ave the garbage & rodents are ridiculous"

Facebook · 2023 · on: "The Mayor's Clean-up was a success this morning! Thank you to everyone who participated an..."

"Need to clean up CENTRAL AVENUE ACROSS FROM BOBS THE SIDEWALKS so much greenery needs to be chopped the bus stop is filthy. It's unreal clean all the way down to Oakley's car wash. You can't miss all the dirt and debris that's out there."

Facebook · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "The Mayor's Clean-up was a success this morning! Thank you to everyone who participated an..."

"He should go to rivers edge bar in Mc clean ave . They have enough garbage thrown out and left there to fill a truck ."

Facebook · 2023 · on: "The Mayor's Clean-up was a success this morning! Thank you to everyone who participated an..."

4

Taxes & Cost of Living

6 complaints · 10.7% of all complaints · Instagram 5 · Facebook 1



"Only Spano has the big laugh. Because with his outrageous taxes he knows no one can afford a business in Yonkers!"

Facebook · 2023 · on: ">■Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting| Ruff Ryders 2the Rescue ■ 33 South Broadway (2nd Floor)..."

"Property taxes going up 3%. Rents go up soon too! Elections have consequences."

Instagram · 2023 · on: "Good morning Yonkers Students! Visit any one of the 8 Yonkers sites today and pick up your..."

"My son can't afford all the \$300 sneakers like the south side can cause they don't pay rent I pay a mortgage where's my kick back???"

Instagram · 2023 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano today joined Yonkers Department of Public Works (DPW) Commissioner Thoma..."

5

Crime & Public Safety

5 complaints · 8.9% of all complaints · Facebook 3 · Instagram 2



"We buy these garbage cans like we did with the ones that require the lids and every week they get stolen either either way you're getting screwed by criminals either it is the city issuing tickets or lowlife stealing the cans.."

Instagram · 2023 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano today joined Yonkers Department of Public Works (DPW) Commissioner Thoma..."

"Wow! The state legislature that gave themselves a \$32K raise for working 6 months a year. There's @— who doesn't believe in term limits and yet found money to spruce up the surrounding and easy access to the trail for Greystone's affluent. Yet not enough money for @— and it's teachers. Keep kowtowing to the YPD budgetary wise..."

Instagram · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "CITY OF YONKERS DEDICATES MARTIN GINSBURG PARK IN GREYSTONE NEIGHBORHOOD LINKING WARBURTON..."

"GET THE ILLEGAL LAWN PEOPLE THAT R STILL USING OLD GAS LEAF BLOWERS! They start at 8 am so they cant be caught- Police cant be bothered They have NO permits! This has been ongoing- the gas fumes and dirt they blow around to other properties no less the AIR QUALITY IS COMPROMISED is unacceptable - DO SOMETHING"

Facebook · 2023 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano today announced the launch of the city's new electric leaf blower rebate ..."

6

Parks & Public Spaces

5 complaints · 8.9% of all complaints · Instagram 3 · Facebook 2



"■■ Yonkers parks are dirty and unkept. Trenchard st park is horrible. Unpainted basketball court. Broken glass on the courts and in the grass. Bottles and garbage all over. Broken tree branch's uneven concrete , the list goes on and on. So tell me how you love your parks ????? You should be ashamed you even posted this without looking at your parks."

Instagram · 2023 · on: "It's #NationalParkWeek ! In Yonkers we■and appreciate our parks! During this week we will..."

"It would be nice if something was done for Kingsley Park on Chase Avenue. Many children play there everyday and the playground is rusted which is a health and safety hazard. Also, many people have been asking for a dog park there as well and nothing has been done. The City of Yonkers"

Facebook · 2023 · 6 likes · on: "➤■Ribbon Cutting| State-of-the-Art Playscape at the Ridgeway Mixed-Income Residential Comm..."

"What about Westchester Hills - Rory O'Moore or ball field at School 29?"

Facebook · 2023 · on: "New renovations at Smith Memorial Park were unveiled today, making it the fourth park this..."

7

Roads & Potholes

4 complaints · 7.1% of all complaints · Facebook 2 · Instagram 2

*"Now can you guys form a group that'll fix the roads of pot holes?"*

Facebook · 2023 · 2 likes · on: "The Mayor's Clean-up was a success this morning! Thank you to everyone who participated an..."

"And our roads, sir? Will you be restoring our roads? I know there are many demands. But our roads are the worst I've seen in 20 years."

Instagram · 2023 · on: "YONKERS MAYOR MIKE SPANO PROPOSES FISCAL YEAR 2024 EXECUTIVE BUDGET ■Maintains City Serv..."

"How about the park on hawthorne near knolls Street ■the black tarp has holes and all they do is patch it up"

Facebook · 2023 · on: "New renovations at Smith Memorial Park were unveiled today, making it the fourth park this..."

8

Homelessness & Quality of Life

3 complaints · 5.4% of all complaints · Facebook 2 · Instagram 1

*"How many years have u been letting the illegal lawn people get away w NOT OBEYING THE LAW? Oh and let more in to ruin quality of life like those idiot offspring of theirs reeking havoc on our roads - Quality of Life? NON EXISTENT"*

Facebook · 2023 · on: "■■■REMINDER■■■ ■The Yonkers City Code bans the use of gas-powered leaf blowers to help prot..."

9

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

2 complaints · 3.6% of all complaints · Facebook 1 · Instagram 1

*"Good job Yonkers adding to the chaos. What a joke."*

Instagram · 2023 · 2 likes · on: "Today is National Coming Out Day! On this day we celebrate and support the LGBTQ+ communi..."

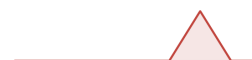
"SUCH BS... MY NEIGHBORS HIRE THESE UNLICENSED LAWN PEOPLE USING GAS POWERED EQUIPMENT LEAVING THE NEIGHBORHOOD W FUME CLOUDS"

Facebook · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "■■■REMINDER■■■ ■The Yonkers City Code bans the use of gas-powered leaf blowers to help prot..."

10

Snow, Flooding & Storm Response

2 complaints · 3.6% of all complaints · Instagram 2

*"How about we replace outdated sewer lines and bring them up to date to decrease flooding every time it rains in Yonkers?"*

Instagram · 2023 · 4 likes · on: "Mayor Mike Spano today announced that he has issued a state of emergency in the City of Yo..."

"Our Wickes and Fowler sewer is still not drained after a call to DPW. They came by and did nothing."

Instagram · 2023 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano today announced that he has issued a state of emergency in the City of Yo..."

Full category ranking

#	Category	Primary	Mentions	Share
1	City Responsiveness & Accountability	11	11	19.6%
2	Schools & Education	8	10	14.3%
3	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	6	8	10.7%
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	6	8	10.7%
5	Crime & Public Safety	5	5	8.9%
6	Parks & Public Spaces	5	5	8.9%
7	Roads & Potholes	4	5	7.1%
8	Homelessness & Quality of Life	3	3	5.4%
9	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	2	2	3.6%
10	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	2	2	3.6%
11	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	2	4	3.6%
12	Housing & Overdevelopment	1	2	1.8%
13	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	1	1	1.8%

"Primary" counts comments whose dominant theme is that category. "Mentions" counts every comment that raises the issue at all, including alongside another complaint, so mentions exceed primary counts for issues that travel together.